

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Are there any thought-oriented roles?



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you think it's important to think something through before you make a decision?
- Are you quick to come up with a solution to a problem? How so?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can talk or report about things, actions, events, or people in a work environment.
- I can talk about team roles.





Let's Explore!

Which role **thrives on*** praise?

* To "*thrive on*" something means to enjoy or be successful in a particular situation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Thought-Oriented Roles

- To "plant" something means to place a seed in the ground so that it will grow into something wonderful, like a tree or flower. People who are "plants" have ideas about how things could be improved in the future. It has been suggested that they are motivated by praise and have difficulty dealing with criticism. Often introverted, it is observed that they prefer to work alone. Since their ideas are novel, they may be considered counter-productive at times. They may not appear to be effective communicators insofar as they tend to ignore traditional constraints.
- Monitor-Evaluators are known to be good at analyzing in that they evaluate the initiatives that plants or other people come up with. It is said that they are wise and equitable. It is believed that they always assess the advantages and disadvantages of an option before making a decision. They are often seen as unemotional or detached inasmuch as they tend to think critically and strategically. However, it is agreed upon that they are not effective motivators in that they are always reacting to situations rather than instigating change.
- Specialists have developed valuable skills and abilities over a period of time. It is assumed that they are proud of their contribution or knowledge of the team. They work hard to maintain their professional status. They are usually introverts and lack interest in other fields. As they are fully committed to their area of expertise, they may come across as territorial. They tend to be preoccupied with small details at the expense of the bigger picture.





Let's Practice!

Thought roles for innovation.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Since their ideas are novel, they may be considered counter-productive at times.
2. As they are fully committed to their field of expertise, they may have come across as territorial.
3. Monitor-Evaluators are known to be good at analyzing in that they evaluate ideas.
4. They may be a poor communicator insofar as they tend to ignore given parameters and constraints.
5. They are critical thinkers and very strategic inasmuch as they are often perceived as detached.



Let's Practice!

Let's talk more about team roles.

Instructions: Read the clues. Select all the correct answers.

Which sentences DON'T use passive report verbs.

1. It has been suggested that they thrive on praise and find it hard to deal with criticism.
2. It is said that most workers don't react well to criticism.
3. People think that most workers like to work in a team.
4. Researchers feel that workers respond better to praise than criticism.
5. It is observed that they prefer to work apart from the team.
6. It is believed that they carefully weigh the pros and cons before coming to a decision.
7. It is thought that hesitation imposes a lot of problems for many.





Extension Activity

Make a summary chart of all the roles.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Work in pairs.
- Make a summary chart of all the team roles presented by Belbin.
- In your chart include all nine role names, their positive contributions, and their allowable weaknesses.
- Display the charts around the class and explain your chart.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I collaborate with a partner.

☐ ☐

I analyze all the positive contributions and weaknesses of each role.

☐ ☐

I create a summary chart that is interesting, easy to understand and informative.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **criticism** (noun): remarks that say what you think is bad about someone or something
e.g. They find it hard to deal with criticism.
- **novel** (adjective): different, unique, unusual
e.g. I think their ideas are novel.
- **counter-productive** (adjective): having an effect that is opposite to the one intended or wanted
e.g. Since their ideas are novel, they may be considered counter-productive at times.
- **parameter** (noun): a set of fixed limits that control the way that something should be done
e.g. They may be a poor communicator insofar as they tend to ignore given parameters.
- **constraint** (noun): rule or regulation that limits your range of action
e.g. They may not appear to be effective communicators insofar as they tend to ignore traditional constraints.
- **detached** (adjective): not reacting to or becoming involved in something in an emotional way
e.g. They are often seen as unemotional or detached.
- **to instigate** (verb): to make something start
e.g. They are always reacting to situations rather than instigating change.
- **territorial** (adjective): careful to guard what you consider to be your own, and prevent others from using it
e.g. They may come across as territorial.
- **at the expense of** (expression): if you do one thing at the expense of another, doing the first thing harms the second thing
e.g. They tend to be preoccupied with small details at the expense of the bigger picture.



Learning Points

Report Verbs with Impersonal Passive Constructions

You can use two different patterns with report verbs: Active and Passive.

For example:

Active: **They say** that it rains a lot in London.

Passive: **It is said** that it rains a lot in London.

You can also use: *It + passive report verb + finite clause* (a clause which can stand alone).

For example:

It is thought that the Pyramids took 25 years to build.

It is known that smoking is not good for health.

It is believed that there is life after death.

This pattern is often used in formal reports, news reports and academic writing.

These are the verbs you can use with this structure:

allege	intend	report
announce	know	reveal
believe	mention	say
claim	notice	see
consider	object	show
declare	observe	state
explain	promise	suggest
feel	prove	think
find	recommend	understand

Examples:

- It has been **suggested** that they thrive on praise and find it hard to deal with criticism.
- It is **observed** that they prefer to work apart from the team.
- It is **believed** that they carefully weigh the pros and cons before coming to a decision.





Learning Points

Reason Clauses Using *in that*, *insofar as*, *inasmuch as*, *since* and *as*

You introduce reason clauses with specific linking words. Each linking word or phrase carries its own meaning and use.

since and **as**

You use **since** and **as** to introduce information you are already aware of.

For example:

Since you've already completed your work, we can go for lunch.

As you're new here, you should introduce yourself to everyone first.

in that, **insofar as**, **inasmuch as**

You use **in that**, **insofar as** and **inasmuch as** to justify what we have just said by indicating that the statement is true. You use these words in fairly formal English.

For example:

She's a pleasure to work for, **in that** she is attentive and motivating.

We are expecting a busy week **insofar as** all the appointments have been booked.

The employees are tired **inasmuch as** they cannot work overtime.

Examples:

- *Since their ideas are novel, they may be considered counter-productive at times.*
- *As they are fully committed to their field of expertise, they may come across as territorial.*
- *Monitor-Evaluators are known to be good at analyzing in that they evaluate ideas.*
- *They may be a poor communicator insofar as they tend to ignore given parameters and constraints.*
- *They are critical thinkers and very strategic inasmuch as they are often perceived as detached.*

